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Are you looking for an easy guide on **how to start a blog**?

The step-by-step guide on this page will show you how to create a blog in 20 minutes with *just the most basic computer skills*.

Ready to start? [Click here to skip to Step #1 of the free guide and start building your blog now!](#)

After completing this guide you will have a beautiful blog that is ready to share with the world.

This guide is made especially for beginners. I will walk you through each and every step, using plenty of pictures and videos to make it all perfectly clear.

If you get stuck or have questions at any point, simply [send me a message](#) and I will do my best to help you out.

My name is Scott Chow, and I am going to show you how to start blogging today. I have been building blogs and websites since 2002. In that time I have launched several of my own blogs, and helped hundreds of others do the same.

I know that starting a blog can seem overwhelming and intimidating. **This free guide is all about blogging for beginners**, and will teach you how to become a blogger with just the most basic computer skills. So whether you're 8 or 88, you can create your own blog in 20 minutes.

I am not ashamed to admit that when I was first learning how to build a blog I made a ton of mistakes. You can benefit from more than a decade of my experience so that you don't repeat these same mistakes when you make your own blog. I created this free guide so that a complete beginner can learn how to blog quickly and easily.

So, just *how do you start a blog*?

Learn how to create a blog in about 20 minutes following these steps:

How to Start a Blog in 6 Steps

1. [Pick a blog name.](#) Choose a descriptive name for your blog.
2. [Get your blog online.](#) Register your blog and get hosting.
3. [Customize your blog.](#) Choose a free blog design template and tweak it.
4. [Write & publish your first post.](#) Share your thoughts with the world. The fun part!
5. [Promote your blog.](#) Get more people to read your blog with the proper marketing.

6. [Make money blogging](#). Choose from several options to monetize your blog.

Should you start a blog?

One of the misconceptions about starting a blog is that you need to be a great writer to be successful. Nothing could be further from the truth. People read blog sites to get a personal perspective on things, so most bloggers write in a very informal and conversational style.

And because of the format, many successful bloggers will **write about a variety of topics** on the same blog.

In addition, you don't need to be an expert on any of the topics you write about to have a successful blog. For example, visitors to a cooking blog don't want to read a textbook from a food scientist, they want to hear the experiences of someone who has actually cooked some real meals, mistakes and all.

To be successful as a blogger there is really just one requirement: a passion for your topic.

At its heart, blogging is about sharing your knowledge with the world. Writing about things that you are passionate about makes the process of starting a successful blog so much easier. As long as you are writing about things that you are genuinely interested in, your passion will shine through and keep your visitors interested.

So why would you go to the trouble of blogging? There are a few reasons:

- **Share your story.** A blog allows you to have a voice and be heard. You can share your story with the entire world if you so choose. One of the most common ways blogs are used are as a diary where the blogger writes about their daily experiences so that friends, family, and others can all be a part of their lives.
- **Make money from home.** Blogging can be quite lucrative if done correctly. The top bloggers in the world obviously earn quite a bit, but even a part-time blogger can expect to make a nice profit if things are done correctly. The best part about it is that blogging is a form of passive income, since you can spend just a few hours a week writing a piece of content and then continue to profit from it long after the the writing is finished. I go into much more detail on how to blog for money later in this guide.
- **Recognition for yourself or your business.** No, you probably won't have paparazzi following you around because of your latest post. But a successful blog makes your idea into a reality, and can gain you a ton of recognition in your respective field. Many bloggers are known as experts just because of their blogs, and some have even gotten book and movie deals based on their blogs.

- **Find a community.** Blogging at its heart is interactive. You write a post and people comment on it. This is a good way to connect with people who are interested in the same things as you are. Blogging allows you to teach these people based on your experience, and it gives you the opportunity to learn from your readers as well.

Ready to begin? [Click here to go to Step #1 of the guide](#)

What is a blog anyway?

In short, **a blog is a type of website that focuses mainly on written content**, also known as blog posts. In popular culture we most often hear about news blogs or celebrity blog sites, but as you'll see in this guide, you can start a successful blog on just about any topic imaginable.

Bloggers often write from a personal perspective that allows them to connect directly with their readers. In addition, most blogs also have a “comments” section where visitors can correspond with the blogger. Interacting with your visitors in the comments section helps to further the connection between the blogger and the reader.

This direct connection to the reader is one of the main benefits of starting a blog. This connection allows you to interact and share ideas with other like-minded people. It also allows you to build trust with your readers. Having the trust and loyalty of your readers also opens up the door to making money from your blog, which is something I discuss later in this guide.

The good news is that the internet is exploding with growth right now. More people than ever are online. This explosion in growth means more potential readers for your blog. In short, if you are thinking about starting a blog then there is no better time than right now.

Let's start your blog!

Step 1: Pick a blog name

The first step is to choose a domain name for your blog. A domain name is the web address for your blog, such as MyNewBlog.com

If you already have a domain name in mind for your blog, then you can **use the domain checker tool below** to make sure that no one else has already registered that name.

If you are not sure what to name your blog, or what topic to blog about, skip to the [next section](#) for helpful tips on how to choose a blog name.

See if your blog name is available:

If your preferred domain name is available, then you can [jump ahead to Step #2 to register your domain name](#)

If you find that the name you wanted is already taken there are a few things you can do:

- **Try a different domain extension.** If the .com version is already registered you may still be able to get the .net or .org version of the name.
- **Add small words.** Words like “a”, “my”, “best”, or “the”. For example, this site is called TheBlogStarter.com instead of BlogStarter.com.
- **Add dashes between words.** For example, scott-chow.com
- **Note:** You cannot use any spaces or punctuation, other than dashes, in a domain name. Capitalization is ignored.

How to Choose a Blog Topic & Name

If you don't have an idea for a name already, the first step is choosing your blog topic.

If you're not sure what to blog about, there are [a few ways to find a good blog topic](#):

- **Life experiences.** Everyone has lessons they have learned through life experience. Sharing this knowledge can be incredibly helpful to others in similar situations.
For example, I recently helped a woman start her blog about being a fireman's wife. She has a lot of experience and knowledge to share with others about this topic, and it has helped her connect with others in similar situations.
Think about the things you have experienced in life. This could be related to your family (example: a blog about being a stay at home mom), work (a blog about experiences dealing with clients), or other life experiences (a blog about dealing with a troubling time such as a disease or divorce, or about a happy time such as preparing for a wedding or a birth of a child).
- **A personal blog.** A personal blog is a blog all about you. This will include a variety of topics, from things you do on a daily basis, to random thoughts and musings. This is a great way to share your thoughts with the world without having to stick to just one topic.
- **Hobbies & passions.** Hobbies or other interests you are passionate about are a great place to start. Cooking, travel, fashion, sports, and cars are all classic examples. But even blogs about hobbies with smaller audiences can be successful, as you are able to tap into a global audience with your blog.

Once you have a topic it's time to choose your blog name, also known as your domain name.

A good blog name should be descriptive so that potential visitors can instantly tell what your blog is about just from the name.

If you are blogging about one specific topic then you will definitely want to include that in some way when you pick a domain name. Try not to get hung-up on just one word though. For example, a cooking blog doesn't necessarily have to have the word "cooking" in it. The words "food", "recipes", and "meals" would also let people know that your blog is about cooking.

If you are planning to create a personal blog where you discuss a variety of topics then I recommend using your name, or some variation of it, since your blog is all about you. For example, I own the blog scottchow.com. You can also add your middle name or middle initial if you find your name is already taken. Or you could use a variation like "Scott Chow Blog" or "Blogging with Scott".

Can't decide on a good name for your blog? [Contact me](#) and I will help you personally (for free)!

Once you have some name ideas you will need to **choose a domain extension**.

A .com domain extension is the most preferred, but .net, .org, .co, or other extension work just as well. It is also important to note that for the purposes of a blog domain you cannot have any spaces between words. So "Blogging with Scott" becomes bloggingwithscott.com

Step 2: Get your blog online

Now that you've got a name picked out it's time to get your blog online.

This might sound hard or technical, so let's go step-by-step to *make the process easy*.

To get your blog up and running you need three things:

1. Domain registration

To claim your domain name and use it for your blog you first need to register it.

2. Blog hosting

A blog host is a company that stores all of the files for your blog and delivers them to the visitor when they type in your blog name. *You must have blog hosting in order to have a blog.*

3. Blogging software

You also need to have the software to build your blog. In this guide I will show you how to build a blog using the *WordPress blogging software*, because it is the most popular, customizable, and easiest to use.

The good news is that these all come packaged together from the blog host I recommend, and the one I show you how to use in this guide: BlueHost.

I personally use [BlueHost](#) and I recommend them for all new bloggers because:

- They will register your custom domain name for free, making sure no one else can take it.
- They offer an automatic free installation of the WordPress blogging software (which I show you how to use in this guide).
- They offer reliable web hosting that has been recommended by WordPress since 2005 and they currently host over 2 million blogs and websites.
- They have helpful 24/7 customer service via phone or web chat.
- They have a 30 day money back guarantee if you are unsatisfied for any reason.